Why China cannot replace India vis-à-vis Nepal?

- India has an advantage of geography on its side. Chinese rail and port connectivity projects are not very feasible owing to the difficult terrain.
- The nearest Chinese ports will be close to 3000 km away while Kolkata and Visakhapatnam ports, which Nepal currently uses are much more closer.

10.7 India – Bhutan Relations



India shares a special relation with Bhutan. Being a land locked country, Bhutan is depended on India for most of its products and financial support and India on its part has been providing all possible support. This makes both the countries ideal example for good neighbourly relations.



King Jigme Wangchuck with his father Ugyen Wangchuck

Timeline of events:

1. **Treaty of Punaksha** (1910): Bhutan become protectorate state of British India. It means Bhutan to have internal autonomy and not external autonomy
2. **Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation(1949) :** India and Bhutan signed the Treaty of Peace and Friendship on August 8, 1949, in Darjeeling.

- The treaty is termed as the continuation of the Anglo-Bhutanese Treaty of 1910. It treats the Himalayas as the sentinel of India's security
- The Indo-Bhutan Treaty is dubbed as the corner stone of Bhutan's foreign policy.

Diplomatic relations between India and Bhutan was established in 1968 with the appointment of a resident representative of India in Thimpu. Before this India's relations with Bhutan were looked after by the Political Officer in Sikkim.

On India's initiative, Bhutan has become a member of the Colombo Plan in 1965, joined Universal Postal Service in 1969 and finally India sponsored Bhutan's membership in 1971. Bhutan's relations with the NAM (Non- Aligned Movement) countries is yet another initiative of India.

	Bhutan – 1949
Non interference in internal affairs	Article 2 – foreign policy to be guided on advice from India.
Defence	Article 6 – no restriction on arms imports as long as not aimed against India or exported to India
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Revised treaty (2007)

- On request of Bhutan, India revised treaty of friendship and cooperation
- It has been suggested that the revised one modifies India's role from guiding partner to a close friend and equal partner.
- Under the revised norms Bhutan no longer require India's approval over importing arms.

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